

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024
INTERNAL SECURITY - 1
Left Wing Extremism

Previous Years' Questions:

1. What are the internal security challenges being faced by India? Give out the role of Central Intelligence and Investigative Agencies tasked to counter such threats. (2023)
2. Naxalism is a social, economic and developmental issue manifesting violent internal security threat. In this context, discuss the emerging issues and suggest a multilayered strategy to tackle the menace of Naxalism. (2022)
3. Analyse the multidimensional challenges posed by external state and non-state actors, to the internal security of India. Also discuss measures required to be taken to combat these threats. (2021)
4. What are the sound determinants of left-wing extremism in Eastern part of India? What strategy should Government of India, civil administration and security forces adopt to counter the threat in the affected areas? (2020)
5. Left Wing Extremism (LWE) is showing a downward trend, but still affects many parts of the country. Briefly explain the Government of India's approach to counter the challenges posed by LWE. (2018)
6. The persisting drives of the government for development of large industries in backward areas have resulted in isolating the tribal population and the farmers who face multiple displacements with Malkangiri and Naxalbari foci, discuss the corrective strategies needed to win the left wing extremism (LWE) doctrine affected citizens back into the mainstream of social and economic growth. (2015)

History

Originated in 1967 in Naxalbari village of West Bengal under the leadership of Charu Majumdar. They believe in far-left radical communist political ideology derived from Maoism. The aim is to change the existing governance structure through violent revolution. They are against the existing democratic structure and consider it exploitative.

It feeds upon the sense of alienation and deprivation among the marginalised communities and inside them to participate in violent revolution against the state. They use the subterfuge of mobilising people over issues of purported inadequacies of the existing system so that they can be indoctrinated to take recourse to violence as the only means for redressal of grievances.

At its peak, the insurgency was active in 40% of India's land mass, with the 'Red Corridor' spanning eastern, central, and southern India (South Asia Terrorism Portal, March 2012).



Evolution of Naxalism in India:

Phase 1:

- Naxalbari incident in 1967 and beginning of violent revolution under the leadership of **Charu Majumdar**.
- The central government considered Naxalbari incident as a mere law and order problem.
- Formation of **All India coordination committee of communist revolutionaries (AICCCR)**.
- Formation of CPI- ML in 1969.

Phase 2:

- "Operation Steeplechase" — a joint Army-Paramilitary-Police operation that was carried out in July-August 1971 to take down Maoists in West Bengal months before the Bangladesh war.
- Charu Majumdar arrested in 1972.
- Maoist struggle continued under the strategy of protracted war.
- CPI ML converted into **People's War group** in 1980

Phase 3- Post 1991

- Economic Liberalization gave new breath to the Maoist support due to land acquisition by private organisations, mining leases etc.
- PWG combined with MCC to form CPI(Maoist)- 2004
- April 2006- PM Manmohan Singh termed naxalism as the single biggest security challenge faced by the country.

Modus Operandi:

1. Delegitimize the existing government through propaganda, exaggerated claims of exploitation, corruption etc.
2. Attack on police and law enforcement machinery, destruction of infrastructure to restrict movement of forces to the hinterlands.
3. Run a parallel government and impose taxes and penalties.
4. Run parallel kangaroo courts in the name of **Jantana Adalat** or **Peoples' Court** to punish people
5. Enforcement of their own social code of conduct.

Factors behind its continuation:

Ideological Factor:

- The ideology remains attractive in a society with a history of discrimination and prevailing socio economic inequalities.
- Many well-meaning liberal intellectuals fall prey to the Maoist propaganda without understanding the true nature of Maoist insurgency doctrine which glorifies violence and believes in adopting the military line to capture power.

Political factors

- Apathy of the political class towards marginalised sections and population in the hinterland.
- Lack of true representation Tribals, Dalits and other marginalised communities.
- Poor functioning of the Gram sabhas, Tribal councils and autonomous councils.

Social factors

- Continuation of social discrimination based on caste and ethnic identities.
- Exploitation and misbehaviour with the female members of weaker sections of the society.
- Attempts by the affluent class to maintain traditional hierarchies in a changed global scenario.

Economic factors

- Limited economic opportunities in the hinterlands and tribal areas.
- Stark economic inequalities that continue to expand.
- Land acquisition 4 mega projects resulting in displacement of tribals.

Administrative factors

- People in tribal areas and hinterlands lack basic communities like food, water, education etc.
- Poor implementation of developmental projects by the administrative machinery
- High levels of corruption at the ground level
- Sense of alienation and discrimination among the poor due to mistreatment, mainly by the police.

- Implementation of laws related to 5th and 6th schedule, land acquisition law, mining laws etc leaves much to be desired.

Cultural factors

- Strong attachment of the tribals with their Jal, Jungle and Jameen.
- Insensitivity of officials towards their cultural values of tribals.

Current Status: (Data provided by the Ministry of Home Affairs)

- LWE violence has shrunk from 465 police stations of 96 districts (2010) to 176 police stations across 45 districts (2022).
- Only 25 districts accounting for 85% of the LWE violence in the country.
- There has been an overall 55% reduction in violent incidents (from 1,136 to 509) and 63 per cent reduction (397 to 147) in Left Wing Extremism (LWE) related deaths in 2021 as compared to 2013.
- Number of deaths of security forces and civilian has declined by 90% from all-time high of 1005 in 2010 to 98 in 2022.

Left Wing Extremism Division of Ministry of Home Affairs

This division was created in October 2006 to effectively address the LWE insurgency in a holistic manner. It implements security related schemes aimed at capacity building in the LWE affected states. The states of **Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, Bihar, West Bengal, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh** and **Kerala** are considered LWE affected, although in varying degrees.

Role and Functions of The Division

- Capacity building of States to combat LWE through schemes of MHA like **Security Related Expenditure (SRE) scheme, Special Infrastructure Scheme, Special Central Assistance** etc.
- Deployment of Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) in LWE affected States.
- Providing funds to the CAPFs for strengthening of infrastructure/ Helicopters/civic action etc.
- Reviewing the security situation in the LWE affected States and issuing advisories to the State Governments concerned.
- Providing assistance to State Governments for initiatives to combat LWE in the form of funds for items of emergent nature.
- Coordinating implementation of LWE related Schemes of other Central Ministries for LWE affected Districts.

Various initiatives to tackle Left Wing Extremism

❖ National Policy and Action Plan 2015 to combat Left Wing Extremism:

- It envisages a multi-pronged strategy involving security-related measures, development interventions, ensuring rights and entitlements of local communities, etc.
- Zero tolerance towards violence
- A big push to developmental activities so that benefits of development reached the poor and vulnerable in the affected areas.

Security approach

❖ Modernisation of Police Force (MPF) Scheme: Its various sub-schemes are

1. **Security Related Expenditure Scheme:** A sub-scheme under the modernisation of police forces scheme. The central government reimburses to the state governments of 10 LW affected states SRE of 70 districts

relating to expenditure on security. Under the scheme, Rs. 306.95 crore have been released in financial year 2021-22.

2. **Special Infrastructure Scheme (SIS):** Under the scheme funds are provided to States for strengthening the infrastructure related to Security.
3. **Scheme of Fortified Police stations:** The Ministry had sanctioned construction of 400 Fortified Police Stations in 10 LWE affected States. All these 400 PSs have been completed.
4. **Civic Action Programme (CAP):** This Scheme is being implemented to bridge the gaps between Security Forces and local people through personal interaction and bring the human face of SFs before the local population.
5. **Media Plan:** The Government is implementing this Scheme in LWE affected areas. Under the scheme activities like Tribal Youth Exchange programmes organised by NYKS, radio jingles, documentaries, pamphlets etc. are being conducted.
6. **Road Requirement Plan-I (RRP-I) for LWE affected areas:** This Scheme is being implemented by Ministry of Road Transport & Highways for improving road connectivity in 34 LWE affected districts of 8 States i.e., Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha and Uttar Pradesh. This scheme envisaged construction of 5,362 km roads lengths in LWE affected States, of which 5058 km roads have been completed (2022).

- ❖ **Multi-Agency Centre (MAC):** MAC at the Central level and State Multi-Agency Centre (SMAC) at the state level have proved to be highly effective in Maoist hotbeds like Jagdalpur and Gaya.
- ❖ **Strengthening of State-Intelligence Bureaus (SIBs) in the LWE affected areas.**
- ❖ The Centre has **expanded the realm of the existing provisions under the Explosives Act and Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2017** to monitor the transportation of the explosive substance and hinder the flow of finances of the insurgents.
- ❖ 14 specialized **CoBRA battalions** of CRPF to assist the states. UAV and mini-UAV have been introduced for each of the CAPF battalions deployed in the Maoist hotbeds.
- ❖ **Operation Green Hunt:** It was started in 2009-10 and massive deployment of security forces was done in the naxal-affected areas.
- ❖ The CPI (Maoist) Party has been included in the **Schedule of Terrorist Organizations** along with all its formations and front organizations under the **Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967**.

Development approach

1. The government started the **Backward Districts initiative (2003-04)** and the **Backward Regions Grant Fund (BRGF) in 2007** under which 55 of the worst affected areas in 9 states were to be provided with funds to the tune of Rs. 2475 crores to tackle the problem of Naxalism.
2. **Integrated Action Plan (IAP)** was launched in 2010 to address the longstanding grievances of Adivasis are enacting few landmark legislations recognizing the rights of Adivasis to access forests for self-governance.
3. **Aspirational District Programme:** The Ministry of Home Affairs has been tasked with the monitoring of Aspirational districts programme in 35 LWE affected districts.
4. **ROSHNI:** It is a special initiative under, **Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana (Formerly Ajeevika Skills)**, launched in June 2013 for **training and placement of rural poor youth** from 27 LWE-affected districts in 09 States.
5. **Universal Services Obligation Fund (USOF):** It provides financial and administrative support to expand mobile services at 4072 tower locations identified by MHA in 96 districts in 10 states.
6. **Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY):** It offers tremendous opportunities for rural road connectivity, thus strengthening the rural economy.
7. **Expanding Minimum Support Price for Minor Forest Produce** and supporting their value addition and marketability through TRIFED.

8. **Health and education:** Schemes like PM-JAY and **Samagra Siksha Abhiyan, Eklavya Model Residential Schools** are also aimed at providing the health and education facilities in the backward regions of our country.
9. **Enabling laws:** Laws like **Rehabilitation and Resettlement Policy, 2007** and **Forest Rights Act, 2006** are also aimed at providing the legal support to the people.

SAMADHAN doctrine: A new security operation doctrine to counter Naxalism announced in May 2017 by the Home Ministry. It is the **one-stop solution for the LWE problem**. It encompasses the entire strategy of government **from short-term policy to long-term policy** formulated at different levels. SAMADHAN stands for-

- **S-** Smart Leadership,
- **A-** Aggressive Strategy,
- **M-** Motivation and Training,
- **A-** Actionable Intelligence,
- **D-** Dashboard Based KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) and KRAs (Key Result Areas),
- **H-** Harnessing Technology,
- **A-** Action plan for each Theatre,
- **N-** No access to Financing.

Specific initiatives by different states:

Andhra Pradesh:

- The **Greyhounds** was raised in 1989 as an elite anti-naxal force.
- The Greyhounds was used between 2004 and 2007 to successfully crack down the top Maoist leaders.
- With separation of Telangana from Andhra Pradesh, Maoist activities in the state have declined significantly

Chhattisgarh:

- **Bastariya battalion** is a unit of CRPF based in Chhattisgarh tasked with curbing naxal activities in the state
- It has also adopted a **Surrender and Rehabilitation policy** and has passed the **Chhattisgarh Special Public Securities Act, 2006**, which expanded the purview of the “unlawful” activities to verbal or oral communications.
- 75 new security camps have been set-up in naxal-hit areas, including 23 camps in Sukma (Worst affected district).
- LWE affected districts of Chhattisgarh: Narayanpur, Bijapur and Dantewada (Abujmahad region) have started selling paddy directly to the government at MSP.

Chhattisgarh New Naxal Eradication Policy

- Triveni action plan of Development-Trust-Security.
- If policeman killed in fight, Rs. 20 Lakhs to buy agricultural land and job for kin.
- If victim is a breadwinner, compassionate appointment or Rs. 15 lakhs to purchase agricultural land.
- Active Naxalite carrying reward of Rs. 5 lakh or more to be given Rs. 10 lakhs on surrender.
- Compensation amount of Naxal Victims doubled.

Jharkhand:

- **Formation of Jaguar** in 2008, modelled on greyhounds of Andhra Pradesh.
- Together with central forces, the state launched **Operation Anaconda** to counter Maoists operating in forested region of Saranda, a maoist stronghold since early 2000s.
- After its success in 2011, the Centre had immediately framed the **Saranda Development Plan in 2012**.
- Naxal strongholds like **Burha Pahar**, tri-junction of **Singbhum, Sarikela-Kharsawan, Khunti** and **Parasnath hills** freed from Maoist presence through establishment of camps and sustained operations by the security forces.

Odisha:

- Odisha has trained thousands of tribal youths from the insurgency-affected areas to recruit them as **Special Police Officers (SPOs)**.
- The state also opened a training school in each of the 7 police ranges, supplemented by 17 battalions of Central forces stationed in key Naxal-affected districts.
- The Maoist related incidents have declined from 42 (2016) to 9 (2017) and in 2015-16, more than 1,000 Maoists have surrendered to the police.

Bihar:

- The government has set up 400-member Special Task Force along with **Special Auxiliary Police (SAP)** for counterinsurgency operations.
- It had also established **specialised counterinsurgency training schools** to improve the combat operation skills of the security personnel.
- The state has been **declared naxal-free** by the CRPF.

Maharashtra:

- Police machinery was strengthened in Naxal-infested areas through training and modernisation of equipment.
- Created a district-level force called **C-60 commando**.
- Surrender and Rehabilitation policy led to the surrender of more than 500 rebels, including some prominent leaders in the past 12 years.
- In Gadchiroli, government has helped 6000 people to become self-employed by providing sewing machines, helped them with vocational courses for photography, beauty parlours, finance to start own business etc.
- All police outposts in remote villages of Gadchiroli have become a single window system called '**Police Dadalora Khidki**' for all government schemes," helping 2.26 lakh tribal villages.

Recent Achievements:

- Recently, about 44 districts were removed from Naxal Affected list, while the "worst affected category" was reduced from 36 to 30.
- In 2022, number of Indian districts reporting Maoist violence decreased by 24%. There has also been a 26 per cent reduction in deaths of security personnel and 44 per cent drop in civilian casualties.
- Recent steps like **Operation Octopus**, **Operation Double Bull** (Bulbul area, Iohardaga, Jharkhand) and **Operation Chakrabandha**, **Operation Thunderstorm** to destroy Naxal boroughs in various places.
- **Burha Pahar** (Jharkhand-Chhattisgarh border) **Chakarbandha** (Bihar), **Bhimabandh** (Bihar) freed from naxal stronghold after 30 years and permanent camps of security forces have been established
- CRPF has declared Bihar as Naxal-free and in Jharkhand also, the influence has been reduced to a minimum.

Emerging Trends:

- Declining number of encounters and death of policemen.
- Use of modern technologies like drones by Naxal groups in Gadchiroli to keep an eye on security personnel.
- Increase in civilian casualties: For example, in Gadchiroli, increase from five casualties in 2021 and 2022 to seven casualties in first five months of 2023.
- Maoists making inroads into new areas: Kerala (Malappuram, Palakkad and Wayanad), Andhra Pradesh (West Godavari), Chhattisgarh (Kabirdham), Madhya Pradesh (Mandla) and Odisha (Angul, Boudh).

Challenges in tackling LWE:

1. Geography- LWE operate in hilly and dense forest terrain. This makes challenging 4 police personal to launch operation against them.
2. Frequent transfer of officials makes it difficult to formulate long term developmental plans of this neglected regions.
3. Attraction towards the ideology and support of influential people becomes impediment to take effective action against them.
4. Cross border support to the Naxal groups in terms of equipments and finances.
5. Huge socio-economic inequality further results in the ideology getting support of a large section of society.
6. Debates around human rights of the Naxals.
7. Inefficient technology and lax implementation of SOPs related to mines detection, drones etc, further hamper the operations.
8. Law and order being state subject, state slack capacity in tackling Naxal menace. This also leads to lack of coordination among states and between centre and states.
9. CAPFs involved in operations are led by IPS officers. These officers lack camaraderie and work culture with the rest of the force.
10. Fake cases against tribals: In July 2022, NIA court in Chhattisgarh acquitted 121 tribals accused of Burkapal Naxal attack, 2017.

Suggestions:

1. Governance- Need for swift implementation of developmental projects related to infrastructure, communication, education, health, and employment.
2. Implementation of provisions under 6th schedule, PESA and Forest Rights Act in its true spirit.
3. Combination of soft and hard approach- convincing theek order to surrender with a generous package while going hard against the non-negotiable top leadership to create fear of the law.
4. Greater engagement with Gram Sabha and other Civil Society Organizations for the purpose of land acquisition.
5. Ensuring true political representation of the tribals and marginalised communities at Panchayat, State Legislature and Parliament levels.
6. Coordination among states and between centre and states to tackle LWE menace. Timely release of SREs by the Centre will help in building trust.
7. Ensuring better equipment, training and technology to the Police forces and CAPFs to be more effective.
8. Engaging civil society organizations for better education, skill development and capacity building of the population. This will help in generating soft power towards the state.

K Vijay Kumar Committee (2014) suggestions on implementation of the Standard Operating Procedures, how to better use the inputs about Naxals and avoid any casualty of security forces.

Urban Naxals:

The phrase Urban Naxals loosely means people of Naxalite bent of mind who reside in urban areas and work as activists, supporters and protectors of the ideology while the active Naxals battle it out in the jungles and vast swathes of Maoist dominated areas.

- Several naxal experts say that it is an old Maoist Strategy to focus on urban centres for leadership, organise masses, build a united front and engage in military task such as providing personnel, material and infrastructure.

- In fact, the leadership of Maoists have generally come from urban, affluent and educated background. For e.g., Charu Mazumdar and Kanu Sanyal, two original architects of Naxalbari revolts came from affluent and non-rural backgrounds.
- Most of the present leadership such as **Ganapathy, Muppalla Laxman Rao, Kobad Ghandy, Anuradha Ghandy**, Saketh Ranjan etc all come from urban backgrounds and have left their comfortable lives in cities to struggle for poor and the exploited out of ideological commitment.
- The Maoist document: **Urban Perspective: Our works in Urban areas in 2007** spelled out strategies and tactics to spread into urban areas and create an elaborate network of underground and over-ground support for the armed movement.

Probable Questions:

1. Left wing extremism related violence, though restricted to specific geographies, present a potent threat. Enumerate the steps take care to tackle left wing extremism.
2. India has achieved significant gains in its fight against Left Wing Extremism, but the threats of its re-emergence remain. Suggest a long-term strategy to nullify the threat.
3. 'Urban Naxals' is a term manufactured to hinder dissent, free speech and critical thinking" Critically Analyze.